

TEA Roadmap and Prioritization Operating Model

INTRODUCTION TO OUR NEW ROADMAP and PRIORITIZATION MODEL

Currently, TEA doesn't have a consistent way to show what work matters most or how it connects to reliability outcomes.

We're changing that!

The below sections describe TEA's **new** way of working. Understanding this new direction provides key context that will enable you to start Q4 planning now.

Key Upcoming Dates

Deadline	What's Due	What This Means
June 12	Q4 PRD ready for review	All PRDs for Q4 must be submitted by this date and score 30 or higher on the PRD quality rubric, indicating they are sufficiently complete for leadership review.
June 26	Fleet Roadmap priorities ready for review	Your fleet roadmap includes the L3s (Initiatives) and L4s (Deliverables) your team plans to commit to for Q4, with clear due dates, estimates, milestones, and a clear view of the top priorities expected to drive the next 8 to 12 weeks.

This page is only a Primer!

Detailed guidance — workflows, ceremonies, field definitions, Jira expectations, and team-specific instructions will be continuously added through the end of June.

6 KEY SHIFTS

Here's what's changing for your team starting now

01 - PRDs for Feature Work Every new feature starts with a PRD that explains why it matters, what success looks like, sequencing, dependencies, and tradeoffs. PRDs must be well-written and outcome-oriented before feature-driven work can start. The DRI (Directly Responsible Individual) drives a PRD from inception through launch and will be reviewed as a critical check before work starts and again once work is completed to demonstrate the value we achieved.	02 - Ship Continuously Teams demo work on a bi-weekly cadence, ensuring progress is visible and feedback can be incorporated early. PRDs should reflect incremental delivery throughout the quarter with value shipped continuously rather than held for a single end-of-quarter launch. This keeps work transparent, reduces risk, and ensures we are always delivering against our most important priorities.	03 - Stronger planning inputs required Each body of work needs: impact, estimation, resourcing, dependencies, success criteria, sequencing, tradeoffs, risks, and decision points. These inputs will be gathered as part of planning
04 - Alliance-level stack rank TEA maintains a continuously prioritized backlog. L3s = initiatives, ranked 1:N alliance-wide. PRDs are categorized into P1s, 10s, 20s, etc.. Alliance rank is primary; fleet and squad stack-ranks are secondary.	05 - Jira usage and estimation required Teams track work in Jira with story points (Fibonacci), clear epics, and traceability between L4s, PRDs, and execution. Teams that build software must follow this important tenet.	06 - Prioritization is continuous Biweekly backlog reviews are the north star, building off our quarterly planning as a foundation. L4s are grouped into priority bands (see below). We want conscious trade-offs of work to ensure we are always working on the most important things.

NEW REQUIREMENTS

The following are the new baseline expectations for all teams under this model.

- Use PRDs for all new feature work, with a clear DRI on each
- Maintain L3/L4 accuracy in TEA Central; map L4s 1:1 to PRDs
- Keep stack ranks current; identify work to stop, delay, or deprioritize
- Capture required planning inputs for each body of work
- Use Jira for execution tracking and estimation
- Surface dependencies and decision needs early

PRIORITIZATION

TEA maintains a continuously prioritized backlog at two levels — **L3s** (initiatives) are stack ranked 1:N alliance-wide, and **L4s** (deliverables) map 1:1 to PRDs for all feature work. L4s are grouped into priority bands (P1–P10 for active work this quarter, P20–P40+ for future candidates) with the alliance-level rank serving as the primary prioritization view.

L3s (Initiatives) Stack ranked 1:N - here is an illustrative list of L3s reflective of the types of buckets we will use for Q4

R a n k	Initiative
1	(example) Critical User Journeys — define and validate CUJs across all 4 brands (Disney+, ESPN, Hulu, ABCN)
2	(example) Super Bowl LXI Readiness — capacity, chaos, and forecast-to-service translation for 2027
3	(example) One-Click Rollback — fast, safe revert path from Ops Dash during incidents
4	...
5	N

L4s (Deliverables) / PRDs will be prioritized using the following high-level scheme (*more details to come*)

Band	Meaning	Status
P1, P10	Active — expected progress or due dates this quarter	ACTIVE
P20 – P40+	Future candidates — important but not yet pulled forward	BACKLOG

CEREMONIES

To support this model, TEA will run a consistent set of biweekly forums designed to create visibility, inspect progress, surface blockers, and keep priorities moving. This list is illustrative for the time being, a full list of ceremonies is expected by May 22nd.

Forum	Purpose
Roadmap demos	Progress and work-in-flight visibility
Intake & prioritization	What moves forward, what doesn't
Dependency tracing	Blockers, cross-team needs, decisions
PRD review	Alignment and approval before slotting

KEY DATES

Q4 planning starts now, with teams surfacing and refining PRD candidates while stack ranking runs continuously in parallel. Everything must be finalized and locked in Airtable by the week of June 22.

- ☑ (DONE) By May 22nd - Additional documentation shared — detailed workflows, meetings and ceremonies calendar, field definitions, Jira expectations, PRD guidance, and team-specific instructions.

- ☐ Now Q4 planning begins immediately. Identify PRDs in the P20–P30 range that may need to move forward, and surface dependencies or resourcing needs.
 - ☐ Ongoing TPMs available to support teams through this change. Karun Karri will set up fleet-level sessions to walk through changes and gather feedback.
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